17. Which one of the following is the most logical, rational and crucial message conveyed by the above passages?

(a) Public research institutions should take the lead in GM technology and priorities the technology agenda.

(b) Developing countries should raise this issue in WTO and ensure the abolition of Intellectual Property Rights

(c) Private corporations should not be allowed to do agribusiness in India, particularly the seed business.

(d) Present India circumstances do not favour the cultivation of genetically modified crops.

Ans : (a) Option (b) is not relevant to this passage. Option (c) is and extreme, and is not stated thus, in the passage. Option (d) is wrong, as the public research institution will invest in technology that can help impart resistance to drought, salinity and other stresses rather than only technologies that work in short run like pest resistance.

18. On the basis of the above passage, the following assumptions have been made :

1. **The issue of effects of natural calamities on agriculture is not given due consideration by GM technology companies.**
2. **In the long run, GM technology will not be able to solve agricultural problems arising due to global warming.**

Which of the above assumptions is/are valid ?

(a) 1 only

(b) 2 only

(c) Both 1 and 2

(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans : (a) Assumption (1) is correct, as that is clearly mentioned in the passage. Assumption (2) is too broad, as it assumes that GM technology will "never" be able to do it, which may be wrong. Hence, option (a) is best.

Passage-2

Most invasive species are neither terribly successful nor very harmful. Britain's invasive plants are no widespread, not spreading especially quickly, and often less of nuisance than vigorous natives such as bracken. The arrival of new species almost always increases biological diversity in a region; in many cases a flood of newcomers drives no native species to extinction. One reason is that invaders tend to colonise disturbed habitats like polluted lakes and post- industrial wasteland, where little else lives. They are nature's opportunists.

19. Which one of the following is the *most logical and rational inference* that can be made from the above passage

(a) Invasive species should be used to rehabilitate desert areas and wastelands of a country.

(b) Laws against the introduction of foreign plants are unnecessary.

(c) Sometimes, the campaigns against foreign plants are pointless.

(d) Foreign plants should be used to increase the biodiversity of a country.

Ans : (c) According to above passage the most logical & rational inference that sometimes, the campaigns against foreign plants are pointless.

Passage - 3

Diarrhoeal deaths among Indian children are mostly due to food and water contamination. Use of contaminated groundwater and unsafe chemicals in agriculture, poor hygiene in storage and handling of food items to food cooked and distributed in unhygienic surroundings ; there are myriad factors that need regulation and monitoring. People need to have awareness of adulteration and ways of complaining to the relevant authorities. Surveillance of food-borne diseases involves a number of government agencies and entails a good training of inspection 'staff. Considering the proportion of the urban population that depends on street food for its daily meals, investing in training and education of street vendors is of great significance.

20. On the basis of the above passage, the following assumptions have been made :

1. Food safety is a complex issue that calls for a multipronged solution.
2. Great investments need to be made in developing the manpower for surveillance and training.
3. India needs to make sufficient legislation for governing food processing industry.

Which of the above assumptions is/are valid

(a) 1 and 2 only

(b) 3 only

(c) 1 and 3 only

(d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans : (a) Assumptions (1) and (2) on food safety is a complex issue that requires multiple solutions and requires huge investment in augmenting manpower for monitoring and training, both are valid as per the above paragraph whereas assumption (3) is not mentioned in the above paragraph. hence it is not true. Hence, the most rational, prudent and decisive option is (a).

Passage - 4

The interests of working and poor people have historically been neglected in the planning of our cities. Our cities are increasingly intolerant, unsafe and unlivable places for large numbers of citizens and yet we continue to plan via the old ways-the static Development Plan---that drawn exclusively from technical expertise, distanced from people's live experiences and needs, and actively excluding large number of people, places, activities and practices that are an integral part of the city.

21. The passage seems to argue

(a) against the monopoly of builders and the interests of elite groups

(b) against the need for global and smart cities

(c) in favour of planning cities mainly for working class and poor people

(d) in favour of participation of peoples' groups in city planning.

Ans : (d) Option (a) and (b) are clearly wrong. Option (c) is not wrong, as it is in line with the argument that "The interests of the working and the poor have historically been neglected in the planning of our cities". But option (d) is the most logical and rational corollary as it also includes option (c). It we start involving groups of people in city planning, automatically we will have the interests of the working class and poor people taken care of. In fact, much more than that is possible.

Passage - 5

A vast majority of Indians are poor, with barely 10 percent employed in the organised sector. We are being convinced that vigorous economic growth is generating substantial employment. But this is not so. When our economy was growing at 3 percent per year, employment in the organised sector was growing at 2 percent per year. As the economy began to grow at 7-8 percent per year, the rate of growth of employment in the organised sector actually declined to 1 percent per year.

22. The above passage seems to imply that

1. **most of modern economic growth based on technological progress**
2. **much of modern Indian economy does not nurture sufficient symbiotic relationship with labour-intensive natural resource-based livelihoods.**
3. **service sector in India is not very labour-intensive.**
4. **literate rural population is not willing to enter organised sector**

Which of the statements given above are correct ?

(a) 1 and 2 only

(b) 3 and 4 only

(c) 1, 2 and 3 only

(d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans : (c) According to the given passage statement (1) is correct because modern economic growth is based on technological progress.

Statement 2 is correct because modern economy and economic growth that is being projected does not reflect the numbers from unorganized sector.

Statement 3 is also correct. Hence option (c) is correct answer.

Passage - 6

India has banking correspondents, who help bring people in the hinterland into the banking fold. For them to succeed, banks cannot crimp on costs. They also cannot afford to ignore investing in financial education and literacy. Banking correspondents are way too small to be viewed as a systemic risk. Yet India's banking regulator has restricted the to serving only one bank, perhaps to prevent arbitrage. Efforts at banking outreach may succeed only if there are better incentives at work for such last-mile workers and also those providers who ensure not just basic bank accounts but also products such as accident and life insurance and micro pension schemes.

23. Which one of the following is the most logical, rational and crucial inference that can be derived from the above passage ?

(a) Efforts to bring people in India's hinterland into the banking system are not successful.

(b) For meaningful financial inclusion, India's banking system needs more number of banking correspondents and other such last-mile workers.

(c) Meaningful financial inclusion in India requires that banking correspondents have diverse skills.

(d) Better banking outreach would be impossible unless each banking correspondent is allowed to serve a number of banks.

Ans : (c) Option (c) is correct because the passage mentions that if the banking correspondents ensured diverse service like bank accounts, life insurance pension scheme etc. Then there are more changes of success at banking outreach. Thus meaningful financial inclusion in India requires that banking correspondents have diverse skills.